

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 737

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Robert Benson "Bob" Brown.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Robert Benson "Bob" Brown; and

WHEREAS, Bob Brown was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, a native Tennessean born in Monterey on October 24, 1934, Bob Brown was the son of E.C. and Gladys Brown and attended school in Monterey, graduating from high school in 1952 and receiving awards for achievements in business and athletics; and

WHEREAS, an exceptional athlete, Mr. Brown led his high school football team, the Monterey Wildcats, to the first state championship in school history; he later played third base for a local baseball team, the Boys of Black Bottom, in games across Tennessee and Kentucky; and

WHEREAS, a proud military veteran, Bob Brown enlisted in the U.S. Army in 1957 and served his country until April 11, 1963, when he returned to civilian life and accepted employment in Chattanooga; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Brown enjoyed a distinguished fifty-seven-year career with the Tennessee Department of Transportation (TDOT), rising from his start as a day laborer to ultimately become Regional Director for Region 2 of the State agency, a position he held until his retirement in 2010; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure at TDOT, he was involved in many projects in the twenty-four county Region 2 area, including the construction of I-24 at Missionary Ridge in Chattanooga and the construction of I-24 West at Monteagle Mountain in the 1960s; and

WHEREAS, to honor Mr. Brown's lifetime of service to the State of Tennessee, the 106th Tennessee General Assembly passed Public Chapter 992 of 2010, which named the administration building at the TDOT campus in Chattanooga the "Robert Brown Administration Building"; and

WHEREAS, an active part of his community in Chattanooga, Bob Brown served as president of the Tyner Youth Association for ten years in support of local youth sports and was honored with the Dizzy Dean Man of the Year Award for the State of Tennessee in 1990; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Brown was also deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Bob Brown is survived by his beloved wife, Shirley Vaughan Brown; his daughter, Holly (Dewey) Williams; his son, Phillip (Pat) Vaughan, Jr.; his grandchildren, Drew and Carlee Williams and Darby Williams; his great-grandchildren, Dallas, Case, and Chandler Williams and Cain Howeth; his nephews, Jeff (Laura) Mitchell, Matthew Mitchell, and Corey (Gina) Mitchell; his niece, Laney Mitchell; and a host of dear friends; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his sisters, Shirley B. Brewer and Mary Ann Mitchell; his brother-in-law, Ned Mitchell, Sr.; his nephew, Ned Mitchell, Jr.; and his aunt, Bessie Brown, who was his greatest influence and mentor from his earliest years; and

WHEREAS, Bob Brown leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Robert Benson "Bob" Brown, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Brown.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.